PIONEER · EDITION 002

The Blueprints Are Out

Vision 2040 | From Zero to Structure

June 2026 · Featuring Rev. Vidar Ligard

Welcome to the era of the Build. The National Director describes the pioneer's spirit, and Rev. Vidar Ligard shares the long obedience behind pioneering Rhema in East Africa.

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FROM THE VISIONNAIRE'S DESK

A Conversation with the National Director, Part II

The foundation of Vision 2040 established, we now delve into the deep spiritual burden of our lineage and the high-stakes urgency of the hour.

Rev. Tokunbo Adejuwon — National Director, Rhema Bible Training Centre Nigeria

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As people begin to respond to this call, what are you looking for in a pioneer?

Among the most important things is the spirit of faith. The spirit of faith is a pioneering spirit — not just someone who says, "I can do it," but someone daring, bold, and ready to attempt the impossible; someone who can see the invisible.

Then, someone who is motivated from within. Someone who does not need people to wind them like a clock — a self-motivated person, what you could call God-motivated and internally driven. Also, someone who is rugged. It takes ruggedness to pioneer anything.

There are people who will be the helmsmen of the pioneering effort, and there are others who may not be the helmsmen but can still be part of the team. Anybody and everybody can be involved. But the person leading a pioneering effort must be bold, daring, full of the spirit of faith, and someone who has imbibed the Rhema DNA.

The ultimate goal is not just schools. The ultimate goal is churches being planted, the lost getting saved, and believers being built up and growing. One of the fastest ways to facilitate these is through Bible school. It accelerates spiritual growth, multiplies labourers, and trains pastors who will go on to pastor and reach others.

Does the person need to have all the money? No. It is the spirit of faith. Even if they do not have a dime, the money will come. We are also looking for someone who is a leader but also a team player. Ultimately, someone who believes "I can", someone who dares, someone who does not mind starting from scratch.

Fear is the biggest hurdle for potential pioneers. What do you believe is the root of this hesitation?

There is fear of failure, fear of the unknown, and fear of giving yourself to something that may not work. But what is the worst that can happen? At least you attempted something. I would rather attempt and fail than fail to attempt. Besides, who even said you would fail?

This is pioneering, but it is a different kind of pioneering. There is a mother organisation in Tulsa with loads of experience and proven success, with over 300 campuses around the world. There is a national headquarters in Nigeria with years of experience doing the same thing.

So there is structure. There is a support system. There are people who will help you. There is a family that is there for you. People have done this and succeeded. We can learn from their successes and also from the things that did not work.

The truth is, you will not fail. We are going to train people. They are not just on their own. There is a safety net and a structure in place to help them succeed. It is simply for someone to say, “Yes, I am going.” And we will say, “Great, you are not on your own. We are with you.”

> *It takes ruggedness to pioneer anything.*

> *I would rather attempt and fail than fail to attempt.*

PIONEER BLUEPRINT

The Road Less Travelled

An interview with Rev. Vidar Ligard, Director of Rhema Kenya.

Rev. Vidar Ligard — Director, Rhema Kenya · Founder, Safari Mission

> Rev. Vidar Ligard has trained leaders and transformed people across East Africa since 1999. Together with his wife, Rev. Cathrine, he founded Safari Mission, working in Kenya and Congo. A graduate of Oral Roberts University and Rhema Bible Training College, Tulsa, he reflects here on the long obedience, family conversations, cultural learning, and practical preparation that pioneering demands.

How did your pioneering journey start, and how did you eventually end up in Kenya?

Long before I knew Rhema, I knew I was called to Africa when I was six years old. I was eight years old when I realized I needed to go to Tulsa. I read one of Brother Hagin’s books at eight years old and realized, “He knows something I do not know.” In my heart, I knew I needed to go to Tulsa for training.

It was not until I sat in Rhema in Ministry Gifts class that I realized my calling was a pulpit calling. I knew I was supposed to work in Africa, so I looked for opportunities to go. Through the early

ministry we did in Kenya, we taught and trained pastors, and the call evolved to the place where I realized we needed to start Bible colleges.

What major challenges did you have to overcome before starting the work in Kenya?

As missionaries, first put your own finances in order. A lot of people want to pioneer something, but they are full of consumer debt. That creates complicated challenges. Usually the biggest challenge is financial: how you will support yourself, raise support, and financially sustain the work.

There are family challenges too. Unless you are single, you have a family, and you must make sure there is agreement. If you have children, you must make sure they are taken care of. Startup costs must also be considered.

On the ground, every place has a different culture. Take time to understand the culture, the church landscape, tribal boundaries, gatekeepers, and city fathers. These are steps a lot of people miss.

How did you navigate cross-cultural differences while pioneering?

You will make mistakes. If you genuinely care about the people you are ministering to, that love will shine through and help you overcome cultural mistakes. You need to walk in love and humility towards the culture you are in.

Every culture has unbiblical challenges. Do not address them on day one. Earn respect in the culture before dealing with issues. You also need maturity to separate your home culture from biblical culture so you do not impose your culture and call it biblical.

For someone going into a new nation without knowing anyone there, how do they begin to build a team?

Take time and make a lot of short-term trips into the area where you want to minister. Minister in churches, run mini seminars or Rhema taster sessions, and get to know people in that place.

You need strategy. Are you setting up smaller campuses, or are you putting in place a large campus that can accommodate one thousand or five thousand people? The larger you want the work to become, the more time you should spend preparing. That also affects the type of team members you need.

What role does partnership play?

Wherever we set up a campus, we start with a long-term budget. What should this place look like after it becomes self-sustaining? Then we look at student numbers, tuition rates, and estimates.

Partnership can come from students with more financial capacity than tuition requirements. Long-term partnership usually comes from alumni. Until you have alumni, partnership may come from existing campuses that get excited about the new work.

What qualities or competencies must a pioneer possess?

If you are going into a new country or culture, there needs to be a God-calling to pioneer. Administratively gifted people are valuable and needed, but somebody still needs to be called as a pioneer if the work is going to succeed.

If you are expanding within the same country, maybe an administratively gifted person can open a campus successfully. But if you are going somewhere culturally difficult, you probably need someone truly called as a pioneer.

What would you say to someone who is afraid to start?

You cannot mix the spirit of faith and fear. You have to ask yourself whether the spirit of faith is really there or whether fear is dominating.

There are uncertainties when you start a new work. There has to be a fire in you and a spirit of faith bigger than the uncertainty. If that is not there, go help somebody else first. Most people should probably serve longer than they think because there are things that get built into you.

What is your final advice to someone preparing to pioneer a new work?

I know of no better life than to step out over the aching void of nothingness with nothing but the Word of God underneath your feet. It is scary in the natural, but what an exciting ride it is when you are truly standing on the Word of God. You just have to make sure the Word of God is really under your feet.

> *I know of no better life than to step out over the aching void of nothingness with nothing but the Word of God underneath your feet.*

> *To win the market, you speak the local tongue; to win the academy, you speak the language of the classroom.*

COUNTRY FOCUS

The Republic of Liberia

To win a nation, you must first know its story.

POPULATION SIZE

~5.5 Million

A smaller, concentrated population makes it possible to create national impact quickly from the capital, Monrovia.

DOMINANT RELIGION

Christianity 85%

While highly Christianised, there is a zero-to-structure gap in systematic Word-of-Faith training.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Protestant / Pentecostal

There is high receptivity to the Word, but civil unrest has left a vacuum in leadership development.

LITERACY RATE

~48%

Orality and radio are powerful tools here. Teaching must be clear, relatable and accessible.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

English & Liberian Kreyol

No language barrier for Nigerian pioneers makes Liberia a high-speed entry point for expansion.

YOUTH POPULATION

~60% under 25

A post-war generation is rising, hungry for a new-creation identity that moves them past national history.

URBAN VS RURAL

Strong Urban Pull

Monrovia is the gateway. Establishing a hub there serves as the altar for the rest of the counties.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Limited / Denominational

Most training is academic or theological. Rhema practical faith training is rare and needed.

DID YOU KNOW?

Liberia was founded by free people of colour from the United States in 1822 and became Africa's first independent republic. The name originates from the Latin word "Liber," meaning free.

THE 10/40 GAP

Liberia is south of the 10/40 window, but it can serve as a strategic English-speaking base for the Mano River Union: Liberia, Sierra Leone and Guinea.

STATE FOCUS

Oyo State

The Pacesetter State.

GEOPOLITICAL ZONE

South-West

Oyo sits in a historically influential region with strong educational and church infrastructure.

POPULATION SIZE

~8 Million

Ibadan is one of Africa's largest cities by landmass, requiring multiple hubs rather than one centre.

DOMINANT RELIGIONS

Christianity & Islam

Oyo is a model of religious co-existence. The focus is demonstration, not religious debate.

CHRISTIAN EXPRESSION

Orthodox, Aladura, Pentecostal

The challenge is not a lack of churches but deep discipleship and training in the Word of Faith.

LITERACY RATE

~75%

An intellectual climate where systematic, logical, scriptural Rhema training is well suited.

PRIMARY LANGUAGES

Yoruba & English

Yoruba is essential for streets and rural outskirts; English serves city centres.

YOUTH POPULATION

~65%

Numerous tertiary institutions create a large pool of young labourers ready to be trained and deployed.

BIBLE SCHOOLS

Several Denominational Seminaries

The body of Christ in Oyo is craving practical training in how to walk by the Spirit.

PIONEER PRO-TIP

The Legacy Strategy

In Oyo State, respect for ancestry and legacy is deep. Do not come as a new thing that disregards the old. Come as a strengthener of the body. Position Rhema as the training arm that helps existing churches produce better leaders.

THE BIBLICAL OG OF PIONEERING

Abraham

The man who started without a map.

God said, “Go.” Abraham said, “Where?” God said, “I will show you.” Before Google Maps, relocation allowances, and strategic site surveys, there was Abraham: just a direction and a decision.

01. Story Time — Pack Your Life. I’ll Explain Later.

Abraham was settled. Life was stable. Familiar. Predictable. Then came the instruction that has launched more destinies than any strategy session ever has:

> *Get out of your country… to a land that I will show you.*
>
> GENESIS 12:1

Notice the tense? God didn’t say, “the land I have shown you.” He said, “the land I will show you.” In simple terms: pack your life. We’re going somewhere. I’ll explain later. Abraham set out with no itinerary, no brochure, and no five-year plan. He just packed the tents and went.

02. Pioneer Lesson — Your Yes Must Be Louder Than Your Where

Abraham didn’t move because he understood everything. He moved because he trusted the One who spoke. Sometimes, the call is simply the command to leave the known for the promise. If you’re

waiting for complete certainty before you move, you're not pioneering. Real pioneering begins when your yes is louder than your where.

03. Modern Mirror — Go, Not Recklessly, But Obediently

Many people feel that same nudge today: "Start something." "Go there." "Take the Word closer to them." Then come the questions: Where exactly? With what resources? How will it work? Abraham's answer is simple: Go. Not recklessly, but obediently.

MYTH VS FACT

Myth: Abraham was a young, restless guy looking for adventure. Fact: He was 75 years old. Vision 2040 is not just for the youth; it is for anyone whose spirit is still young enough to obey. Myth: He lived in a tent because he was poor. Fact: He was extremely wealthy. He lived in a tent because he was mobile — and refused to settle down while looking for a city whose builder and maker is God.

THE ALTARS STRATEGY

Everywhere Abraham went, he built an altar. In Vision 2040 terms, an altar is a campus: a physical mark in a territory that says, "The Word of God is here now." Every study group or training hub is a modern-day altar in the Sahel or on the coast.

> *Real pioneering begins when your yes is louder than your where.*